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What should or should not be there in my CV?

A good CV will have the following sections: objective, personal strengths, academic background, academic achievements (if any), extracurricular activities, project details, areas of interest, and personal and contact details. It should have neat and simple formatting. Ideally, it should be of 2–3 pages.

Some characteristics of a bad CV can be as follows: overly complex formatting or styles; typos, grammatical mistakes; either too short (1 page), or too long (> 3 pages); too many personal details (e.g., parent's occupation, 3rd consolation prize in Rangoli competition); list of weaknesses, etc.

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How detailed should the CV or résumé be?

The CV or résumé should ideally have adequate details about one's job history or academic details, project details and achievements.

The job history should be from the current work experience to details of the first job (i.e., in reverse chronological order) giving the name of the company, role/position and number of years (preferably with joining and leaving dates). The academic details should cover the college/university, course, year of passing, percentages/CGPA, etc. Project details should include the title, where it was done, software used, and a short description of the project. Other sections can be very brief and to-the-point.

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How should I prepare for written tests?

To prepare for written tests, the following should be taken care of:

- Know the general format of the question papers from IT companies. Typically, most of the IT companies cover some or all of the following topics:
 - programming aptitude (C, data structures, algorithms, etc)
 - quantitative aptitude
 - analytical ability
 - reasoning (logical, critical, etc)
 - verbal skills (synonyms, grammar, composition, etc)
 - puzzles
- Try solving the previous years' sample question papers
- Attempting to solve previous years' sample question papers is very important. This helps you know where you stand, get experience in answering questions quickly in the actual written test, and, in general, become confident of clearing the written test.
- Read relevant books
 - GRE (Barron's guide)
 - R.S. Aggarwal's aptitude books (quantitative aptitude, reasoning, etc)
 - Shakuntala Devi's puzzle books ('Puzzles to Puzzle You', 'More Puzzles to Puzzle You', etc)
 - Technical books ('Let us C', etc.)

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How should I prepare for attending an interview?

In the first place, know the basic details about the company—its main business, size, etc. If possible, visit the company's website and get to know the general details about the company. This helps to show that you are interested in the company when related questions are asked in the interview.

An experienced person looking for a job change needs to know about the current position he is applying for (the job profile), what is expected from a person in that position, and how he can fit into that position.

An important aspect in cracking the interview is your attitude (i.e., how you present yourself). Show keen interest, be attentive and listen to the interviewer. Other aspects to look out for are eye contact, body language, appearance, way of speaking, showing respect, etc. Also, be on time for the interview (e.g., start early if traffic jams are common in your city).

Knowing the latest advances in technology and other happenings in your technical domain would be an added advantage.